

Licensure Exam for Teachers

LET EXAM Reviewer



- Most Comprehensive LET Reviewer in the Web!
- With Rationale, Guides and Practice Tests
- Contains 600+ pages! Get 98% Passing Rate!

Table of Contents

INTRODUCTION	1
 PART I – GENERAL EDUCATION COMPONENT	10
 English	10
Parts of Speech.....	10
Correct English Usage	34
Basic Rules in Agreement and Grammar	67
The Use of Figurative Language	65
Literature	79
 Filipino	103
Bahagi ng Pananalita	103
Panitikan	147
 Mathematics	164
Developing Problem Solving Skills	164
Tips and Strategies in Solving Mathematical Problems	178
Mathematical Review	180
Fundamental Operations	182
Order of Operations	188
Exponents and Powers	189
Fractions	189
Decimals	192
Integers	194
The Number Line	194
Plane Geomerty	199
Algebra	207
 Natural Science	208
Definition of Science	208
Steps to Scientific Method	209
Biology	210
Cell Theory	214
Ecology	214
Important Terms in Ecology	215

Soil Problems	218
Water Problems	219
Forces that Shape the Earth's Crust	220
Earthquake	221
Weather and Climate	221
Severe Weather Bulletin	225
Meaning and Description of the Modified Public Storm Signals	225
The New Public Weather Forecast	229
Eclipse	229
Tides	229
The Solar System	230
 Social Science	 231
Philippine History and Government	231
Political Science	248
Constitution	254
Human Rights	284
Economics	286
Taxation	289
 PART II – PROFESSIONAL EDUCATION COMPONENT	 292
 Facilitating Learning, Child and Adolescent Development	 292
Human Growth and Development	292
The Biological and Psychological Bases of Education	292
Sociological Bases of Education	313
Anthropological Bases of Education	316
 Teaching Profession	 320
Education	320
Educational Contributions of Ancient Civilizations	322
Educational Influences of Jesus Christ	327
The Different Medieval Movements in Education	328
Philosophical Movements in Education	332
Psychological Movements in Education	336
Legal Bases of Philippine Educational System	338
The Historical Development of Philippine Educational System	377

Curriculum Development	385
Schools of Thought in Curriculum Development	385
Dimensions in Curriculum Development	385
Guidelines for Curriculum Development	386
Approaches to Curriculum Design	387
Curriculum Patterns	387
The Curricula of Philippine Schools	389
2002 Basic Education Curriculum	401
Understand by Design (UbD) Curriculum	407
The K-12 Program	413

Principles of Teaching, Educational Technology

Field Study, Practice Teaching	414
Types of Principles of Teaching	414
The Inborn Tendencies of the Child	415
Multiple Intelligence	416
Characteristics of the Filipino Learners	423
Learning	423
Theories of Learning	423
Laws of Learning	425
Factors that Affect Learning	425
The Learner	426
The Teacher and the Learning Process	427
Classroom Management	428
The Art of Questioning	430
Hierarchy of Questions	431
Lesson Planning	434
List of Behavioral Objectives	440
Teaching Methods/Strategies	445
Guidance and Counseling	460
Counseling	467

Educational Technology

Education	479
Technology	479
Educational Technology	479

Theories	480
Use of Audio Aids	481
Device	482
Nonprojected Audiovisual Aids	483
The Use of Technology in the Classroom	483
 Assessment of Learning	 485
Measurement and Evaluation	485
Classification of Tests	485
Criteria of a Good Examination	486
Page 1	
Stages in Test Construction	493
Statistical Measures or Tools used in Interpreting Numerical Data	502
 Social Dimensions of Education	 510
The Four Pillars of Learning	510
Ethics	511
Values	513
Defective Norms of Morality	515
Modern Philosophies of Education	516
Oriental Philosophy	521
 PART III – PRACTICE EXAMINATIONS	 528
English	528
Filipino	536
Mathematics	540
Natural Science	547
Social Science	556
Facilitating Learning, Child and Adolescent Development, Teaching Profession and Curriculum Development.....	565
Principles and Methods of Teaching, Field Study, Educational Technology and Practice	575
Assessment of Learning	586
Social Dimensions in Education	596
Last page	609

The Philippine Teachers Professionalization Act of 1994: Its Implications to Teacher Education

Pursuant to the provision of Section 1 Article XIV of the 1987 of the 1987 Constitution that “the State shall protect and promote the right of all citizens to quality education at all levels and shall take appropriate steps to make such education accessible to all”. The Philippine Teachers Professionalization Act of 1994 (Republic Act No. 7836) was promulgated.

This was signed into law by President Fidel V. Ramos on December 16, 1994. The above mentioned law amends and/or supersedes the provisions of P.D. (No. 1006 or the Teachers Professionalization Decree of 1976, which was the basis of the Professional Board Examination for Teachers (PBET). This act aimed towards (1) the promotion, development and professionalization of teachers and the teaching profession and (2) the supervision and regulation of the licensure examination for teachers.

To this effect, the Professional Board Examination for Teachers which was traditionally administered by the National Board for Teachers, an agency attached to the Department of Education, Culture, and Sports in coordination with the Civil Service Commission, will be administered by the Professional Regulations Commission (PRC) starting August 1996.

The Professional Board for Teachers

The teacher’s examination including its rules and regulations will be enforced through a collegial body called the Board for Professional Teachers, under the supervision of the PRC. They are appointed by the President of the Philippines based on the recommendations of the accredited associations of teachers. Pursuant to the provisions of the law, the board shall be composed of five (5) members who shall be (a) citizens of the Philippines, (b) at least 35 years old, of proven integrity, and possess high moral

values in their professional and personal conduct and have not been convicted of any offense involving moral turpitude, (c) holder of a Bachelor's degree in Education or Bachelor of Arts and preferably holders of a master's degree or doctorate degree in education or its equivalent, (d) professional teachers with valid certificate of registration and valid professional license, except those who shall compose the first Board for Professional Teachers, (e) have been professional teachers in the active practice of the teaching profession for at least ten (10) years in the elementary and secondary level, and (f) not officials or members of the faculty of, nor have a pecuniary interest in any university, college, school or institution conferring a bachelor's degree in education or its equivalents for at least three (3) years prior to their appointment, and neither connected with a review center or with any group or association where review classes or lectures in preparation for the licensure examination are offered or conducted.

Examination and Registration

All applicants for registration as professional teachers shall be required to pass a written examination which shall be given at least once a year in places and dates as the board may determine upon the approval by the PRC. A valid certificate of registration and a valid professional license from the PRC are required before any person is allowed to practice as a professional teacher in the Philippines.

The examination for the elementary and secondary school teachers shall be given separately. The results of the examination shall be released within one hundred twenty (120) days after the date of examination. In this connection, a professional license signed by the Chairman of the PRC and bearing the registration number and date of issuance and the expiration and renewability shall be issued to every registrant who has paid the annual registration fees for three consecutive years. This license shall serve as evidence that the license can lawfully practice his profession.

Periodic Merit Examination

Aside from the licensure examination, a professional teacher is encouraged to grow professionally by taking a Merit Examination once in every five years as provided by

section 19 of this law, the result of which shall serve as the basis for merit promotion as well as for salary adjustments. However, no fee shall be required in taking the merit examination.

A teacher who fails to pass the merit examination will be allowed to take the examination for the second time. If he fails, he shall be required to take a CHED accredited refresher course or program before being allowed to take another examination. However, failure in the merit examination shall not be used as ground for dismissal or demotion.

But those who passed shall be awarded a diploma of merit by the board, earn merit points for purposes of salary adjustment or promotion to higher position or grade level, be placed in priority list for government scholarship, and enjoy other benefits as may be provided by the board. Moreover, the law provides that these incentives shall be extended to those teachers who make inventions, develop new methods of teaching, write a book or books and create works of artistic merit.

Registration and Exception

The Board for Professional Teachers shall publish a roster of professional teachers, date of registration, their names and addresses and other pertinent data. Furthermore, as provided by Section 26, two years after the effectivity of this law, no person shall engage in teaching and/or act as professional teacher whether in the pre-school, elementary or secondary level, unless he is a duly-registered professional teacher and a holder of a valid certificate of registration. Applications for license as a professional teacher may be issued without examination under the following circumstances:

Page | 4

- a) a holder of a certificate of eligibility as a teacher issued by the Civil Service Commission and the CHED;
- b) registered professional teacher with the National Board for Teachers under the CHED pursuant to P.D. 1006;
- c) an elementary or secondary teacher of five (5) years in good standing and a holder of a Bachelor's degree in Education or its equivalent;
- d) An elementary or secondary teacher for three years in good standing and a holder of a master's degree in education or its equivalent.

The teachers who fall under the above circumstances are given two years from the organization of the Board for Professional Teachers within which to register and be included in the roster of professional teachers. Those incumbent teachers who are not qualified to register without passing any examination or qualified yet failed to register within the two year period shall be issued a temporary special permit. Furthermore, those who failed in the licensure examination for professional teachers shall be eligible as para-teachers.

On the other hand, this law also provides for a fine of not less than five thousand pesos (Php5, 000) nor more than twenty-thousand pesos (Php20, 000) or imprisonment of not less than six months nor more than five years, or both, (at the discretion of the court) to any person, school or school official found guilty of violating the provisions of this law.

THE “LET” AND QUALITY EDUCATION

The law which professionalizes the teaching profession and placing the authority of administering the licensure examination for teachers to the Professional Regulations Commission is a laudable endeavor. Yet it is just one of those herculean tasks that the

Page | 5

State through the CHED needs to accomplish soonest in order to rectify the turbulent maladies that are now pestering the entire educational system.

The teacher is the most important factor in the educative (teaching-learning) process. The teacher with his personality has the capacity either to make or break the young minds that are entrusted to his care. Therefore, the teacher holds in his hands the future of this nation. No wonder why the oft-quoted EDCOM report in 1991 considered the teachers as the heart of the problem.

That same report stated that the teachers are poorly trained and most of them in any level of education do not have the minimum qualifications for teaching. It is indicated that the deplorable performance can be traced to poor teaching training and the low quality of students enrolled in teacher training institutions.

This allegation no matter how hard it is for us in the field of education to accept its veracity has an inherent truth in it. This is due to the fact that teaching is a poorly esteemed profession nowadays. Gone are those years when teachers were the helm of the public's eyes and were considered to be the most honorable people in any society.

For this, teaching can no longer attract the best high school graduates. The prevalent psyche today is that if you are bright and talented as much as possible you should avoid being a teacher and instead take up law, medicine, engineering and other high paying professions. Whereas, if you are mediocre student, teaching is the easiest course for you to get a college diploma.

What has really happened to the noblest profession? What did the government do to save this noble calling from the mire of misery and from its deteriorating condition?

Page | 6

These questions are just the proverbial “tip of the iceberg” in so far as the horrible state of teaching in the Philippines is concerned.

As expected, nobody is willing and courageous enough to accept the blame. Instead, the different sectors involved are pointing an accusing finger at each other and upbraiding one another.

The government for its part will point to the provision of Section 5 Article XIV of the 1987 Constitution as its contribution to alleviate the plight of the poor teachers, for this mandates that the State should give the highest budgetary priority to education, so as to attract the best available talents into becoming teachers.

However, it is easier said than done. As it is mentioned in this book (Foundations of Education II), teaching has already lost its traditional glory and glamour. It is now considered a horrible if not a disgusting profession. Teachers are now demoralized and somehow “demonetized” professionals. To this effect nobody dares to take the challenge of educating our youth and worst even those already in the field are

leaving their calling as teachers to serve as domestic helpers, baby sitters, and even entertainers in foreign countries.

The enrolment of teacher training schools in Metro Manila and even in the whole country is declining. Well, no one can blame and force the student to be teachers if they cannot be promised with a bed of roses once they decided to enter the portals of the teaching profession. If they have other alternatives to make more money, surely they would not dare embark on the gargantuan and seemingly unrewarding task of being a teacher.

Page | 7

But of course there are other idealists who would content that teaching is not a money making machine, but rather a calling, a vocation that needed an unwavering devotion and commitment. And in the words of Socrates of ancient Greece, if the teachers teach because of salary, they are degrading the reputation of the profession and reducing it to a mere income-generating endeavor.

Again, these words are easier said than done. I firmly believe that teachers are just human beings like any other professional. They need what everybody needs. Teachers cannot teach with an empty stomach. They cannot teach if they have nothing to wear. They cannot teach effectively if their families are starving and are dying because they have no money to buy the necessary medicine.

Moreover, almost all the studies conducted in the past until now, since the Monroe Survey of the 1920's and the Swanson Survey of the 1950's up to the current report of the EDCOM revealed the same thing – teachers are poorly paid and trained. So what else is new? If the proper authorities will not execute decisive actions on this matter with a sense of urgency, one day we will wake up to see that our country and her citizens are already in the arid and barren field of ignorance, misery and intellectual deprivation.

If we truly care for the future of our children who are, since time immemorial considered as the hope of the nation, we will seriously consider the gravity of the problem and will do all means to thwart these boisterous dilemmas that threaten our very existence. Yes, it is true that teachers need to be properly trained and be fully equipped to qualify them

to teach our children.

Hence, there is a need to professionalize them through the licensure examination.

However, if the government continues to ignore their plea for better compensation and brighter future in their chosen career, and instead of responding constructively to their

Page | 8

clamor when they go to the streets to seek redress for their grievances, the same “humane” government slaps them with threats of suspension and even dismissal from services, we cannot expect these teachers to teach effectively and be satisfied with their work, thus, we definitely cannot expect quality education. This is due to the fact that the students are just as good as their teachers, and as the Lord Jesus Christ stressed in Matthew 22:14, “no student is better than his teacher.”

The state authorities still claim that there is not enough money to fully implement the salary increase of teachers because the government does not have enough budget for this task. But if we try to carefully and objectively analyze the actual situation, we will realize that the national budget is devoured by the “foreign debt servicing scheme” via the provisions of P.D. 1177, which prescribes that the lion share of the annual budget (General Appropriations Act) be set aside to pay our foreign debts.

But sad to say all initiatives in the Congress to repeal this burdensome Marcos’ decree has never prospered for reasons only the gentlemen in the Senate and House of Representatives know. And to add insult, to injury the national budget is further depleted by the “pork barrel” which amounts to several billions of pesos yearly given to senators and congressmen deceitfully labeled as countrywide development fund (CDF), which more often than not leads to budgetary deficits.

And if there is a need for more revenues to finance the whims of the government, there is always an easy way to generate funds – levy more taxes to the people, just like Expanded Value Added Tax.

If the government can afford to appropriate more than 35% of the national budget to

congressmen their respective pork barrels by the millions and can increase the monthly salary of the legislators by 100% overnight, why can't it spare the lowly paid teachers a small amount to augment their income? Are junketing, electioneering, and paying the private armies and others more important than educating our people?

Every opening of the school year the CHED announces that there is a need for more teachers to meet the needs of increasing enrolment. In order to address this problem of lack of teachers, the CHED has to schedule as many as three teaching shifts, offer multi-grade classes (a teacher handles at least two different grades at the same time in one class) and increase the class size to 60 or 70 pupils per section. And as revealed by the teachers in the rural areas and far flung provinces, they are already handling as much as 70 to 90 students per section.

Indeed, how can we expect quality education under this set-up? No matter how efficient a teacher is and regardless of his rating in the licensure and the subsequent merit examination, he is definitely incapacitated to control more than 90 students per section, much more delivering the goods to them. The way it seems the Philippine society particularly the government is asking too much from the teachers and yet giving them too little. With these in mind we cannot help it but ask ourselves that if education is expensive let us try the cost of ignorance.

The Role of Teacher Training Institutions

James A. Garfield, the 20th President of the United States once said that "a good teacher on one end of a log and interesting pupil on the other will make a university anywhere." Based on this premise, no country can ever offer quality education to its constituents in the absence of quality teachers. However, efficient and dedicated teachers are not miraculously produced. They are the result of long and tedious work of the people involved in teacher training. These can be done through improving the

curricula of the Education programs based on the requirements of the LET, and the curricula of the basic education (i.e. NESC and NSEC), hiring highly qualified administrators, and faculty and non-teaching personnel, employing modern technology in the training of the prospective teachers and providing them with sufficient pre-service training. These and other necessary steps are implemented so as to equip future teachers with skills and competencies that they badly need not only in hurdling the Licensure Examination but also in dealing with the harsh realities that the world of teaching would offer them in the future.

These and other innovations would surely contribute to the achievement of the constitutional mandate of providing quality education to all citizens at all levels and making such education accessible to all. This I believe is the true spirit of democratic education.

PART I

GENERAL EDUCATION COMPONENT

Part I of the Licensure Examination for Teachers is devoted to General Education subjects with a weight of 20% consisting of English, Filipino, Mathematics, Natural Science and Social Science.

ENGLISH

The English component of the General Education portion of the Licensure Examination for Teachers includes Study and Thinking Skills, Writing in the Discipline, Speech and Oral Communication, Philippine Literature and Word Literatures.

PARTS OF SPEECH

Parts of speech is used to describe the mechanism of the language, in other words, the grammar which is defined as the art of speaking and writing the language correctly

according to the rules in general. The parts of speech are noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition, conjunction and interjection.

NOUN

Nouns are names of persons, places, events, things, or ideas. Example: lawyer, province, table, New Year, freedom

Kinds of Nouns

1. Proper nouns – are specific and written in capital letter.

- Example: Danica, Atty. Dined, Christmas, Taft Ave.

2. Common nouns – are general.

- Example: house, girl, street, teacher, country

3. Collective nouns – name groups

- Example: team, crowd, organization

4. Mass nouns – cannot be counted.

- Example: hair, sugar, water, sand, stars

5. Concrete nouns exist in the physical world

- Example: flower, moon, chair, bag, bottle

6. Abstract nouns – refer to ideas and feelings.

- Example: love, independence, honesty, faith

Number of Nouns

- Singular – refers to one noun.

- Plural – refers to two or more nouns.

Rules in forming the plural of nouns:

1. Most nouns add s to the singular form.

• Ex.: boy + s = boys, room + s = rooms

2. Nouns ending in a hissing sound (s, chi, she, x or z) add is.

• Ex.: box – boxes, church – churches, match – matches, dish – dishes

3. Most nouns ending in f or fee change f to vet before adding s.

• Ex.: calf – calves, knife – knives, leaf – leaves

4. Most nouns ending y preceded by a consonant sound usually change y to i and add es.

• Ex.: city – cities, lady – ladies, reply – replies

5. Nouns ending in y after a vowel, add s.

• Ex.: key – keys, alley – alleys, monkey – monkeys

6. Some nouns ending in o preceded by a consonant add es.

• Ex. : cargo – cargoes, tomato – tomatoes, hero – heroes

7. A few very common nouns add en or change the vowel or remain unchanged.

• Ex.: ox – oxen, child – children, sheep – sheep

Page | 13

8. Most compound nouns, add s or es to the principal words of the compound. •

Ex.: bookcase – bookcases, handful – handfuls, runner-up – runners-up 9. Some nouns function collectively.

• Ex.: information, battalion, artillery, furniture, equipment, jewelry

Cases of Nouns

1. Nominative – used as the subject, noun of address, predicate noun or appositive.

Examples:

a. Danica looks pretty in her red dress.

- b. Celine, come and get your toys.
 - c. The winner in the oratorical contest in Czarina.
 - d. Dr. Dioneda, our new professor discusses the lesson well.
2. Objective – used as direct object, indirect object, or object of the preposition.
Examples:

- a. The students are playing basketball.
 - b. Charles sent Lourdes a love letter
 - c. The concert was held in the part.
3. Possessive – used to show ownership or possession. Examples:
- a. Mother's bag is colorful
 - b. The house' gate is newly painted

PRONOUNS

A pronoun is a substitute for nouns. Examples: he, she, they, ours, those.

Antecedent of the pronoun – the noun to which a pronoun refers. A pronoun must agree with its antecedent in gender, person, and number.

Kinds of Pronouns

1. Demonstrative pronoun. Examples:
- This (singular) – used to point near object.
 - These (plural) – used to point near objects.
 - That (singular) – used to point far object.
 - Those (plural) – used to point far objects.

2. Indefinite pronoun. Examples:

- singular – any, anybody, anyone, nobody, no one, anyone, anything, each, everyone, one, someone, somebody, every, either, neither, everything

- plural – all some, few, both, several, many

3. Interrogative pronoun – who, which, what, whom, whose, whoever, whomever

Page | 15

Below is the table of personal pronouns, their cases and persons:

	Nominative Case	Objective Case	Possessive Case
SINGULAR			
1 st person	I	me	my, mine
2 nd person	You	You	Your, yours
3 rd person	He, she, it	Him, her, it	His, her, hers
PLURAL			
1 st person	We	Us	Our, ours
2 nd person	You	You	Your, yours
3 rd person	They	Them	Their, theirs

First (1st) person refers to the speaker.

Second (2nd) person refers to the person spoken to.

Third (3rd) person refers to the person(s) spoken about.

VERB

A verb expresses action or state of being.

Ex. yell, interpret, feel, are

Forms of Verb

No s, No d/ed, No ing.

1. The base-form educate, learn, write
2. The S-form for third person singular noun or pronoun; educates, learns, writes
3. The ing-form or present participle; educating, learning, writing
4. The past form; educated, learned, wrote

Kinds of Verb

1. **Regular verbs** form their past tense by the addition of **d**, or **ed** to the base form.

They have the same form both for the past tense and past participle.

Base form	S-Form	Present Participle	Past and Past Participle
No s/d//ed/ing	(used for third person singular noun or pronoun)	ing form	Ending in d/ed
cook	cooks	cooking	cooked
decorate	decorates	decorating	decorated
play	plays	playing	played

2. Irregular verbs form their past tense and past participle in several ways.

Base form	Past tense	Past participle
come	came	come

break	broke	broken
seek	sought	sought
cut	cut	cut

PAST FORM OF SOME IRREGULAR VERBS

Base Form	Past Form	Past Participles
	A	
arise	arose	arisen
awake	awoke	awaken
	B	
backslide	backslid	backslidden/backslid
be	was, were	been
bear	bore	born / borne
beat	beat	beaten / beat
become	became	become
begin	began	begun
bend	bent	bent

bet	bet	bet
bid	bid/bade	bidden
bind	bound	bound
bite	bit	bitten
bleed	bled	bled

blow	blew	blown
break	broke	broken
breed	bred	bred
bring	brought	brought
broadcast	broadcast	broadcast
build	built	built
burst	burst	burst
buy	bought	bought
	C	
cast	cast	cast
catch	caught	caught
choose	chose	chosen
cling	clung	clung
come	came	come

cost	cost	cost
creep	crept	crept
cut	cut	cut
	D	
deal	dealt	dealt
dig	dug	dug
do	did	done
draw	drew	drawn

drink	drank	drunk
drive	drove	driven
dwell	dwelt	dwelt
	E	
eat	ate	eaten
	F	
fall	fell	fallen
feed	fed	fed
feel	felt	felt
fight	fought	fought
find	found	found

flee	fled	fled
fling	flung	flung
fly	flew	flown
forbid	forbade	forbidden
forecast	forecast	forecast
foresee	foresaw	foreseen
foretell	foretold	foretold
forget	forgot	forgotten / forgot
forgive	forgave	forgiven
forsake	forsook	forsaken
freeze	froze	frozen

	G	
get	got	gotten / got
give	gave	given
go	went	gone
grind	ground	ground
grow	grew	grown
	H	
hang	hung	hung

have	had	had
hear	heard	heard
hew	hewed	hewn
hide	hid	hidden
hit	hit	hit
hold	held	held
hurt	hurt	hurt
	K	
keep	kept	kept
kneel	knelt	knelt
knit	knit	knit
know	knew	known
	L	
lay	laid	laid

lead	led	led
leave	left	left
lend	lent	lent
let	let	let
lie	lay	lain

light	lit	lit
lose	lost	lost
	M	
make	made	made
mean	meant	meant
meet	met	met
misunderstand	misunderstood	misunderstood
mow	mowed	mown
	P	
partake	partook	partaken
pay	paid	paid
proofread	proofread	proofread
prove	proved	proven
put	put	put
	Q	
quick-freeze	quick-froze	quick-frozen
quit	quit	quit

	R	
read	read	read

rid	rid	rid
ride	rode	ridden
ring	rang	rung
rise	rose	risen
run	ran	run
	S	
saw	sawed	sawn
say	said	said
see	saw	seen
seek	sought	sought
sell	sold	sold
send	sent	sent
set	set	set
sew	sewed	sewn
shake	shook	shaken
shave	shaved	shaven
shed	shed	shed
shine	shone	shone
shoot	shot	shot

show	showed	shown
shrink	shrank	shrunk
shut	shut	shut
sing	sang	sung
sink	sank	sunk
sit	sat	sat
slay (kill)	slew	slain
sleep	slept	slept
slide	slid	slid
sling	slung	slung
slink	slinked	slunk
slit	slit	slit
sow	sowed	sown
speak	spoke	spoken
speed	sped	sped
spell	spelled	spelt
spend	spent	spent
spill	spilled	spilt
spin	spun	spun

spit	spit / spat	spit / spat
split	split	split

spread	spread	spread
spring	sprang / sprung	sprung
stand	stood	stood
steal	stole	stolen
stick	stuck	stuck
sting	stunk / stank	stunk
strew	strewed	strewn
stride	strode	stridden
strike (delete)	struck	stricken
strike (hit)	struck	struck
string	strung	strung
strive	strove	striven
sublet	sublet	sublet
swear	swore	sworn
sweep	swept	swept
swell	swelled	swollen
swim	swam	swum

swing	swung	swung
	T	
take	took	taken
teach	taught	taught
tear	tore	torn

telecast	telecast	telecast
tell	told	told
test-drive	test-drove	test-driven
test-fly	test-flew	test-flown
think	thought	thought
throw	threw	thrown
thrust	thrust	thrust
tread	trod	trodden / trod
	U	
understand	understood	understood
undertake	undertook	undertaken
undo	undid	undone
	W	
wake	woke	woken

waylay	waylaid	waylaid
wear	wore	worn
weave	wove	woven
wed	wed	wed
weep	wept	wept
win	won	won
win	won	won
wind	wound	wound

withdraw	withdrew	withdrawn
withhold	withheld	withheld
withstand	withstood	withstood
wring	wrung	wrung
write	wrote	written

3. **Linking verbs** are used to link or join the subject with a word in the predicate which related to the subject. The be form of the verb (am, is, are, was, were) is the most commonly used linking verb. Others are the verbs of the senses: become, seem, look, smell, appear, feel, taste, sound, remain.

Page | 28

Linking verbs in sentences:

1. My favorite color is red.
2. He looks great in black.
3. My friend became famous.

Tense

Tense means time

Present tense. A verb is in the present tense if:

- a. The sentence expresses a permanent action.
 - Ex. The sun rises in the east and sets in the west.
- b. It shows habitual action.
 - Ex. He goes to church every Sunday.
- c. It expresses an on-going action.
 - Ex. The students are researching in the library now.

Past tense. A verb is in the past tense if it expresses a completed

action. Ex.: They transferred to a new building yesterday.

She gave alms to the beggar.

Nica recited the poem well.

Future tense. A verb is in the future tense if it expresses an action that is yet to be done.

It is a verb phrase using the auxiliary verbs **will/shall** + the simple form of the verb.

Ex.: Will you visit me tonight?

Page | 29

They will pass their projects next week.

I shall return.

Am / is / are + going to also expresses future tense.

Ex.: I am going to Baguio.

The friends are going to perform on stage.

ADJECTIVES

Adjectives are words that describe, limit or modify nouns and pronouns. Ex.: warm, quick, tall, blue, interesting

Adjectives answer the questions “Which one?”, “What kind?” and “How many?”

The Uses of Adjectives

1. A noun modifier is usually placed directly before the noun it describes. Ex.: He is an intelligent man.

2. A predicate adjective follows a linking verb and modifies the subject. Ex.: He is happy.

The movie seems interesting.

3. An article or noun marker are other names for these adjectives: a, an,

the Ex.: Dorothy was given an apple.

The teacher is awarded for her meritorious performance.

The new born is a baby boy.

Kinds of Adjective

1. ***Indefinite Adjective***: some, many, much, several, few, a few, a great deal of little, a little.

a. *With countable nouns*: Ex. I have (many, several, few) books at home.

b. *With uncountable nouns*: Ex. I have (much, a great deal, little) information on history.

c. *With both plural countable and uncountable nouns*. Ex. He has (some, a lot of, enough) money.

d. The indefinite adjectives much, many, little and few may be modified by too and very. Ex. You are making too much noise.

2. ***Numerals***: one two, three, etc., are cardinal numbers.

Ex. He gave me three roses.

While numerals like first, second, third, etc., are called ordinal numbers. Ex. We will discuss the third chapter.

3. ***Descriptive adjectives***: new, tall, blue, charming.

Ex. The charming woman is my aunt.

4. ***Proper adjective***: Filipino flag, English language, Persian carpet, etc.

Ex. Persian carpets are on sale at the mall.

5. ***Nouns that modify nouns***: oak, paper, etc.

Ex. Here is your history book.

6. ***Phrases and clauses that modify nouns***:

Ex. The girl watching television is my sister.

7. A clause modifying a noun is usually introduced by a relative pronoun: that, which, who, whom, whose and where.

Ex. The man who is driving the car is my father.

ADVERB

An *adverb* modifies a verb, an adjective, or another adverb. Ex. fast, slowly, well, very

Adverbs answer the questions, “How?”, “Where?”, “When?”, “How often?” and “To what degree?”

Adverbs should not be used to modify nouns.

Kinds of Adverb

1. Adverb of Manner (how)

Ex. He spoke (poorly, fluently, slowly).

Written Exercise: Change the following adjectives to adverbs by adding *ly*.

1. slow
2. merry
3. graceful
4. quick
5. quiet
6. careful
7. courageous
8. weak
9. easy
10. neat

2. Adverb of time (when)

Ex. He is coming (tomorrow, next week, next month, tonight).

Written Exercise: Underline the time expression used in each of the following sentences.

1. The doctor will check him up very soon.
2. Are you going to Baguio this summer?
3. I could not sleep well lately.
4. The students complained about their grades last week.
5. They will spend their vacation in Baguio in April
6. My sister will see the dentist later on.
7. He hopes to finish college next year.
8. It rained hard last night.
9. Mother is baking a cake right now.
10. Yoly is happy all this morning.

3. ***Adverb of place (where)***

Ex.: Let us meet in the restaurant.

The concert will be in the park.

4. ***Adverb of frequency (how often)***

Ex. He writes to him (daily, regularly, weekly).

5. ***Adverb of negation/affirmation***

Ex. Yes, no, not, never, always, absolutely definitely

CONJUNCTIONS

Conjunctions connect words or group of words.

Ex. and, but, or, for, yet, therefore, also, however, because, so that, as long as

Ex. I will love you as long as the grass shall grow.

PREPOSITION

Preposition shows the relation between a word and a noun or pronoun that follows. It indicates:

a. **place and position** – at, in, across, above, below, between, behind, beyond b.

direction and motion – in, towards, out, about, around, through, by, down, over c.

time – at, before, after, during, since, until

Ex. I have been waiting for your call since last week.

INTERJECTION

Interjection expresses emotion, acts as a signal, or adds a conversational touch. It usually ends with an exclamation point.

Ex. ouch! , what! , wow! , hurray!

Ex. Hurray! Ginebra won the game.

VERBALS

Verbals are used as modifiers or nouns in the subject, object, predicate complement or object of a preposition.

Three Kinds of Verbal

Page | 34

1. **Infinitive** – to + the simple form of the verb (no s, no d, or ed, no ing) Ex. To speak is necessary to improve one's English.

2. **Gerund** – verb + ing

Ex. Speaking is necessary to improve one's English.

3. **Participle** is a word that is formed from a verb and used as an adjective. Ex.

Speaking English always, she acquired the mastery of the language.

CORRECT ENGLISH USAGE

Accede – means to agree with.

Concede – means to yield, but not necessarily in agreement.

Exceed – means to be more than.

We shall accede to your request for more evidence.

To avoid delay, we shall concede that more evidence is necessary.

Access – means availability

Excess – means too much.

The lawyer was given access to the records of the company.

The expenditures this month are far in the excess of income.

Accept – means to take when offered.

Except – means excluding. (preposition)

Except – means to leave out. (verb)

Page | 35

The hero gladly accepted the 'keys to the city.

All the food except the vegetables were eaten by the children.

The school excepted her from taking gym classes because of her illness.

Adapt – means to adjust or change

Adopt – means to take as one's own

Adept – means skillful

Children can adapt to changing conditions very easily.

The orphan was adopted by the young couple.

Proper instruction and practice will make you an adept chess

player. *NOTE: adapt to, adopt by, adept in or at.*

Adapted to – implies original or natural suitability.

The gills of the fish are adapted to underwater breathing.

Adapted for – implies created suitability.

Atomic energy is constantly being adapted for new uses.

Adapted from – implies change to be made suitable.

The movie was adapted from the best selling book.

Addition – means the act or process of adding.

Edition – means printing of a publication.

Page | 36

In addition to a dictionary, he always uses a thesaurus. The first edition of Duka's book was published in 1997.

Advantage – means a superior position.

Benefit – means a favor conferred or earned (as a profit).

He had an advantage in experience over his opponent.

The rules were changed for his benefit.

NOTE: to take advantage of, to have an advantage over.

Adverse – (pronounced AD-verse) means unfavorable.

Averse – (pronounced a-VERSE) means disliking.

He took the adverse decision poorly.

Many students are averse to criticism from their classmates.

Advise – means to give advice. Advise is losing favor as a synonym for notify.

Acceptable: The teacher will advise the student about study habits.

Unacceptable: We are advising you of a delivery under separate cover.

(SAY: notifying)

Affect – means to influence. (verb)

Effect – means an influence. (noun)

Effect – means to bring about. (verb)

Page | 37

Your education must affect your future.

The effect of the last war is still being felt.

A diploma effected a tremendous change in his attitude.

NOTE: *Affect also has a meaning of pretend.*

She had an affected manner.

After – is unnecessary with the past participle.

SAY: After checking the timetable, I left for the station.

DON'T SAY: After having checked (omit after) the timetable, I left for the station.

Ain't – is an unacceptable contraction for am not, or not, or is not.

Aisle – is a passageway between seats.

Isle – is a small island

All ready – means everybody or everything is ready.

Already – means previously

They were all ready to write when the teacher arrived.

They had already begun writing when the teacher arrived.

Alright – is unacceptable.

All right – is acceptable

All-round – means versatile or general.

Page | 38

All around – means all over a given area.

The decathlon champion is an all-round athlete.

The policemen were lined up at Luneta Grandstand.

All together – means everybody or everything together.

Altogether – means completely.

The boys and girls sang all together.

This was an altogether different computer from the other office.

All ways – means in every possible way.

Always – means at all time.

She was in all ways acceptable to the voters.

His reputation had always been remarkable.

Allude – means to make a reference to.

Elude – means to escape from

It is almost impossible for one to elude tax collectors.

Allusion – means a reference

Illusion – means a deception of the eye or mind.

The student made allusions to his teacher's habits.

Illusions of the mind, unlike those of the eye, cannot be corrected with glasses.

Page | 39

Alongside of – means side by side with.

Bill stood alongside of Henry.

Alongside – means parallel to the side.

Park the car alongside the curb.

Alot – is unacceptable. It should always be written as two words a

lot. Among – is used with more than two persons or things.

NOTE: Amongst should be avoided.

Between – is used with two persons or things.

The inheritance was equally divided among the four children.

The business, however, was divided between the oldest and the youngest one.

Amount – applies to quantities that can be counted only one.

Number – applies to quantities that cannot be counted one by

one. A large amount of grain was delivered to the storehouse.

A large number of bags of grain was delivered.

Annual – means yearly.

Biennial – means once in two years or every two years.

Anywheres – is unacceptable.

Page | 40

SAY we can't find it anywhere.

ALSO SAY nowhere (NOT nowhere),

Somewhere (NOT somewhere)

Aren't I – is colloquial. Its use is to be discouraged.

SAY: AM I not entitled to an explanation?

(preferred to Aren't I...)

As – (used as a conjunction) is followed by a verb

Like – (used as a preposition) is Not followed by a verb.

Do as I do, not as I say.

Try not to behave like a child.

Unacceptable: He acts like I do.

As far as – expresses distance.

So far as – indicates a limitation.

We hiked as far as the next guest house.

So far as we know, the barn was adequate for night's stay.

As good as- should be used for comparisons only.

This buildings is as good as the next one.

Note: As good as does Not mean practically.

Unacceptable: They as good as promised us a place in the hall.

Page | 41

Acceptable: They practically promised us a place in the hall. as if – is correctly used in the expression ."He talked as if his jaw hurt him" Unacceptable: "He talked like his jaw hurt him."

Ascent – is the act of rising.

Assent – means approval.

The ascent to the top of the mountain was perilous. Congress gave its assent to the President's emergency power. Assay – means to try or experiment.

Essay – means an effort or, the result of an effort.

We shall assay the ascents of the mountain tomorrow. The candidate's views were expressed in a well-written essay. Attend to – means to take care of.

Tend to – means to be inclined to

One of the clerks will attend to mail in my Absence. Lazy people tend to gain Weight.

Back – should NOT be used with such words as refer and return since the prefix re means back.

Page | 42

Unacceptable: Refer back to the text, if you have difficulty recalling the facts

Backward and backwards – both are acceptable and may be used interchangeably as adverb.

We tried to run backward (or backwards).

Backward as an adjective means slow in learning. (DON'T say backwards in this case)

A backward pupil should be given every encouragement.

Berth – is a resting place.

Birth – means the beginning of life.

The orphans were given a new berth near the sea. He was a fortunate man from birth.

Beside – means close to.

Besides – means in addition to.

He lived beside the stream.

Besides being a lawyer, she was a skilled musician.

Better – means recovering.

Well – means completely recovered.

He is better now than he was a week ago.

In a few more weeks, he will be well.

Page | 43

Both – means two considered together.

Each – means one of two or more.

Both of the applicants qualified for the position. Each applicant was given a generous reference. *Note: Avoid using such expressions as the following:*

Both girls tried to out do the other. (Use each girl instead.) They are both alike (Omit both).

Breath – means an intake of air.

Breathe – means to draw air in and give it out.

Breadth – means width.

Before you dive in, take a very deep breath.

It is difficult to breathe under water.

In a square, the breadth should be equal to the length.

Bring – means to carry toward the person who is speaking.

Take – means to carry away from the speaker.

Bring the books here.

Take your raincoat with you when you go out.

Broke – is the past tense of break.

Broke - is unacceptable for without money.

He broke his arm.

“Go for broke” is a slang expression widely used in gambling circles.

Celine accidentally broke the vase.

Bunch – refers to things.

Group – refers to persons or things.

This looks like a delicious bunch of bananas.

What a well – behaved group of children!

Note: The colloquial use of bunch applied to persons is to be discouraged. A bunch of the boys were whooping it up.

(Number is preferable).

Certainly – (and surely) is an adverb.

Sure – is an adjective.

He was certainly learning fast.

Unacceptable: He sure was learning fast.

Cite –means to quote.

Sight – means seeing

Site – means a place for building.

He was fond of citing from the Scriptures.

The sight of the wreck was appalling.

The Board of Directors is seeking a site for the new building.

Coarse – means vulgar or harsh

Course – means a path or a study

He was counseled because of his coarse behavior.

The ship took its usual course.

Which course English are you taking?

Come to be - should NOT be replaced with the expression become to be, since become means to come to be.

Comic - means intentionally funny.

Comical – means unintentionally funny.

A clown is a comic figure.

The peculiar hat she wore gave her a comical appearance.

Conscience – means sense of right

Conscientious – means faithful.

Conscious – means aware of one's self.

Man's conscience prevents him from becoming completely selfish.

We all depend on him because he is conscientious.

The injured woman was completely conscious.

Considerable – means sense of right.

Cease – means to end.

Seize – means to take hold of.

Will you please cease making those sounds?

Seize him by the collar as he comes around the corner.

Cent - means a coin.

Scent – means an odor.

Sent – is the past tense of send.

The nine-cent postal card is a thing of the past.

The scent of roses is pleasing.

We were sent to the rear of the balcony.

Calendar – is a system of time.

Calendar – is a smoothing and glazing machine.

Colander – is a kind of sieve.

We measure our calendar year from January 1 through December 31. In

ceramic work, the potting wheel and the calendar are indispensable.

Garden-picked vegetables should be washed in a colander before cooking.

Page | 47

Can – means physically able.

May – implies permission.

I can lift this chair over my head.

You may leave after you finish your work.

Cannot help – must be followed by an – ing form.

We cannot help feeling (NOT feel) distressed about his.

NOTE: *CANNOT HELP FEELING BUT IS UNACCEPTABLE.*

Can't hardly – is a double negative. It is unacceptable.

SAY: The child can hardly walk in those shoes.

Capital – is the city

Capitol – is the building.

Paris is the capital of France.

The Capitol in Washington is occupied by the congress.

NOTE: Capital also means wealth.

Compare to – means to liken something which has a different form.

Compare with – means to compare persons or things with each other when they are of the same kind.

Contrast with – means to show the difference between two

things. A minister is sometimes compared to a shepherd.

Page | 48

Complement – means to a completing part.

Compliment – is an expression of admiration.

His wit was a complement to her beauty.

He complimented her attractive hairstyle.

Consul – means a government representative

Council – means an assembly that meets for deliberation.

Counsel – means advice.

Americans abroad should keep in touch with their consuls.

The City Council enacts local laws and regulations.

The defendant headed the counsel of his friends.

Convenient to - should be followed by a person.

Convenient for – should be followed by a purpose.

Will these plans be convenient to you?

You must agree that they are convenient for the occasion

Copy – is an imitation of an original work.(not necessarily and exact imitation) Facsimile – is an exact imitation of and original work.

The counterfeiters made a crude copy of the one thousand peso bill.

The official government engraver, however, prepared a facsimile of the bill.

Page | 49

Could of – is unacceptable. (Should of is also unacceptable)

Could have – is acceptable. (Should have is acceptable.)

Acceptable: You could have done better with more care

Unacceptable: I could of won.

ALSO AVOID: must of, would of.

Decent – means suitable.

Descent – means going down.

Dissent – means to disagreement.

Allusion – reference to something.

Illusion – means to a wrong idea that will probably not influence
action. People were under the delusion that the earth
was flat.

It is just an illusion that the earth is flat.

Desert – (pronounced DEZZ-ert) means an arid area.

Desert – (pronounced di-ZERT) means to abandon; also a reward or
punishment. Dessert – (pronounced di-ZERT) means the final course of a meal.

Page | 50

The Sahara is the world's most famous desert.

A husband must not desert his wife.

Lifetime imprisonment was a just desert for his crime.

We had leche plan for dessert.

Different from – is acceptable.

Different than – is unacceptable.

Acceptable: Jack is different from his brother.

Unacceptable: Baguio's climate is different than Manila's climate.

Doubt that – is acceptable.

Doubt whether – is unacceptable.

Acceptable: I doubt that you will pass this term.

Unacceptable: We doubt whether you will succeed.

Dual - means relating to two.

Duel – means a contest between two persons.

Dr.Jekyll had a dual personality.

Both the wrestlers were fatally injured in a duel.

Due to – is unacceptable at the beginning of a sentence. Use because of, on account of, or some similar expression instead.

Unacceptable: Due to the rain, the game was postponed.

Page | 51

Acceptable: The postponement was due to the rain.

Each other – refers to two persons.

One another – refers to more than two persons.

The two girls have known each other for many years.

Several of the girls have know one another for many years.

Either... or – is ised when referring to choices.

Neither...nor – is the negative form.

Either you or I will win the election.

Neither Bill nor Henry is expected to have a chance.

Eliminate – means to get rid of.

Illuminate – means to supply with light.

Let us try to eliminate the unnecessary steps.

Several lamps were needed to illuminate the corridor.

Emerge – means to rise out of.

Immerge – means to plunge into. (also immerse)

The swimmer emerged from the pool.

The student totally immersed himself in his studies.

Emigrate- means to leave one's country for another.

Immigrate – means to enter another country.

Page | 52

The Norwegianse migrated to America in the mid -1860's

Many of the Norwegian immigrants settled in the Middle West.

Everyone – is written as one word when it is a pronoun.

Every one – (two words) is used when each individual is stressed.

Everyone present voted for the proposal.

Every one of the voters accepted the proposal.

NOTE: Everybody is written as one word.

Everywheres – is unacceptable.

Everywhere – is Acceptable.

We searched everywhere for the missing book.

NOTE: Everyplace (one word) is likewise unacceptable.

Fell bad – means to feel ill,

Feel bad – means to have a poor sense of touch.

I feel bad about the accident I saw.

The numbness in his limbs caused him to feel badly.

Feel good – means to be happy.

Feel well – means to be in good health.

I feel very good about my recent promotion.

Cool weather always makes him feel well.

Page | 53

Flout – means to insult.

Flaunt means to make a display of.

He flouted the authority of the principal.

The movie star flaunted her sexy body.

Formally – means in a formal way.

Formerly – means at an earlier time.

The letter of reference was formally written.

She was formerly a delegate to the convention.

Former – means the first of two.

Latter - means the second of two.

The former half of the book was in prose.

The latter half of the book was in poetry.

Forth – means forward.

Fourth – comes after third.

They went forth like warriors of old.

The fourth honor is Danica.

NOTE: spelling of forty (40) and fourteen (14)

Get – is a verb that strictly means to obtain.

Please get my bag.

There are many slang forms of GET that should be avoided:

Page | 54

AVOID: Do you get me? (SAY: Do you understand me?)

AVOID: YOU can't get away with it. (SAY: You won't avoid punishment if you do it.)

AVOID: Get wise to yourself. (SAY: Use common sense.)

AVOID: We didn't get to go. (SAY: We didn't manage to go.)

Got – means obtained.

He got the tickets yesterday.

AVOID: You've got to do it. (SAY: You have to do it.)

AVOID: We have got no sympathy for them. (SAY: We have no sympathy for them.)

AVOID: They have a great deal of property.)

Hanged – is used in reference to a person. (regular verb)

Hung – is used in reference to a thing. (irregular verb)

The prisoner was hanged at dawn

The picture was hung above the fireplace.

However – means in what possible way.

We are certain, however, that you will like this class.

We are certain that how ever you decide to study, you will succeed.

Page | 55

If – introduces a condition.

Whether – introduces a choice.

I shall go to Europe if I win the prize.

He asked me whether I intended to go to Europe. (not if)

If it was – implies that something might have been true in the past.

If it were – implies doubt, or indicates something that is contrary to fact.

If your book was there last night, it is there now.

If it were summer now, we would all go swimming.

In – usually refers to a state of being (no motion)

Into – is used for motion from one place to another.

The records are in that drawer.

I put the records into that drawer.

*NOTE: "We were walking in the room" is correct even though there is motion,
The motion is not from one place to another.*

Irregardless – is unacceptable.

Regardless – is acceptable.

Unacceptable: Irregardless of the weather, I am going to the
game. Acceptable: Regardless of his ability, he is not, likely to win.

Its – means belonging to it.

It's – means it is.

The house lost its roof due to bad weather.

It's an exposed house, now.

Kind of and sort of – are unacceptable for rather.

SAY: We are rather disappointed with you.

Last – refers to the final member in a series.

Latest – refers to the most recent in time.

Latter – refers to the second of two.

This is the last bulletin. There won't be any other bulletins.

This is the latest bulletin. There will be other bulletins.

Of the two most recent bulletins, the latter is more encouraging.

Lay – means to place.

Lie – means to recline.

NOTE THE FORMS OF EACH VERB:

TENSE LIE (Recline)

Present The child is lying down.

Present perfect The child has lain down.

Page | 57

TENSE LAY (Place)

Present The chicken is laying an egg. Past The chicken laid an egg.

Present Perfect The chicken has laid an egg.

Lightening – is the present participle of to lighten.

Lightning – means the flashes of light accompanied by thunder.

Leaving the extra food behind resulted in lightening the pack.

I don't know, but I would say much rain fell last night.

May – is used in the present tense.

Might – is used in the past tense.

We are hoping that he may come today.

He might have done it if you had encouraged him.

It's I – is always acceptable.

It's me – Is acceptable only in colloquial speech or writing.

Page | 58

It's him}

This is her} always unacceptable

It was them}

It's he}

This is she} always acceptable

It was they}

Number – is singular when the total is intended.

The number of pages in the book is 500

Number – is plural when the individual units are referred to.

A number of pages (in the book) were printed in italic type.

Of any – (and of anyone) is unacceptable for of all.

SAY: His was the highest mark of all. (NOT of any or of anyone)

Off of – is unacceptable for aloud.

SAY: He read aloud to his family every evening.

Outdoor- (and out-off-door) is an adjective.

Outdoors – is an adverb

We spent most of the summer at an outdoor music camp.

Most of the time we played string quartets outdoors.

NOTE: Out- of- doors is acceptable in neither case.

Page | 59

People – comprise a united or collective group of individuals.

Persons – are individuals that are separate and unrelated.

Only five persons remained in the theatre after the first act.

The people of Tacloban have enthusiastically accepted Pope Francis during his visit.

Persecute – means to make life miserable for someone. (Persecution is illegal.) Prosecute – means to conduct a criminal investigation. (Prosecution is

legal.) Some terrorists insist on persecuting others.

The lawyer is prosecuting the criminals.

Precede – means to come before.

Proceed – means to go ahead. (Procedure is the noun)

Sit – means to take a seat. (intransitive verb)

Set – means place. (transitive verb)

NOTE for the forms of each verb.

TENSE SIT (Take a seat)

Present He sits on a chair.

Past He sat on the chair.

Present perfect He has sat on the chair.

Page | 60

TENSE SET (PLACE)

Present He sets the lamp on the table.

Past He set the lamp on the table.

Present Perfect He has set the lamp on the table.

Some time - means a portion of time.

Sometime – means at an indefinite time in the future.

Sometimes – means occasionally.

I'll need some time to make a decision.

Let us meet sometime after twelve noon.

Sometimes it is better to hesitate before signing a contract.

Somewheres – is acceptable.

Supersede – means to replace.

What were the circumstances that preceded the attack?

We can then proceed with our plan for resisting a second attack.

It is then possible that Plan B will supersede Plan A.

Principal – means chief or main (as an adjective); a leader (as a noun)
Principle – means a fundamental truth or belief.

Page | 61

His principal supporters came from the city.

The principal of the school asked for cooperation from the staff.

Humility was the guiding principle of Buddha's life.

NOTE: Principal may also mean as sum placed at interest.

Part of his monthly payment was applied as interest on the principal.
Stationary – means standing still.

Stationery – means writing materials.

In ancient times people thought the earth was stationary.

We bought writing paper at the stationery store.

Stayed – means remained

Stood- remained upright or erect.

The army stayed in the trenches for five days.

The soldiers stood at attention for one hour.

Sure – for surely is unacceptable.

SAY: You surely (NOT sure) are not going to write that!

Taken in – is Unacceptable in the sense of deceive or attend.

SAY: We were deceived (NOT taken in) by his oily manner.

We should like to attend (Note take in) a few plays during our vacation.

Page | 62

Their – means benging to them.

There – means in that place.

They're – means they are.

We took their books home with us.

You will find your books over there on the desk.

Theyre going to the ballpark with us.

Theirselves – is unacceptable.

SAY: Most children of school age are able to care for themselves in many ways.

These kind – is acceptable.

This kind – is acceptable.

I am fond of this kind of apples.

NOTE: These kinds would also be acceptable.

Through – meaning finished or completed is unacceptable.

SAY: We'll finish (NOT be through with) the work by five o'clock.

Try to – is acceptable.

Try and – is unacceptable.

Try to come (NOT try and come)

NOTE: Plan on going iis unacceptable

Plan to go is acceptable

To – means in the direction of.

Too – means more than or also.

There are two sides to every story.

Three twos (or 2's) equal six.

We shall go to school.

We shall go, too.

The weather is too hot for doing outdoor games.

Was – If something is contrary to fact (not a fact),

Were - use were in every instance.

I wish I were in Paris.

Unacceptable: If he was asensible, he wouldn't act like that.

(SAY: If he were . . .)

Ways – is unacceptable for way.

SAY: we climbed a little way (NOT ways) up the hill.

Went and took – (went and stole, etc.) is unacceptable.

They stole (NOT went and stole) our tools.

When – (and where) should NOT be used to introduce a definition of a noun.

Page | 64

SAY: A tornado is a twisting, high wind on land. (NOT is when a

Twisting, high wind is on land.)

A pool is place for swimming. (NOT is where people swim)

Whereabouts – is unacceptable for where.

SAY: Where (NOT whereabouts) do you live?

NOTE: Whereabouts as a noun meaning a place is acceptable.

DO you know his whereabouts?

Whether – should NOT be preceded by of or as to.

SAY: The president will consider the question whether (NOT of

Whether) it is better to ask for or demand higher taxes now.

He inquired whether (NOT as to whether) we were going or not.

Which – is used incorrectly in the following expressions:

He asked me to stay, which I did.

(CORRECT: He asked me to stay and I did.)

It has been a severe winter, which is unfortunate.

(CORRECT: Unfortunately, it has been a severe winter.)

You did not write besides which you have not telephoned.

(CORRECT: omit which)

Page | 65

While – is unacceptable for and the though.

SAY: The library is situated on the south side: (OMIT while) the

laboratory is on the north side.

Though (NOT while) I disagree with you, I shall not interfere with
your right to express your opinion.

Though (NOT while) I am in my office every day, you do not attempt
to see me.

Who – The following is a method (without going into grammar rules) for
determining **When to use who or whom**.

“Tell me (Who, Whom) do you think should represent our company?”

STEP ONE: Change the who- whom part of the sentence to its natural order.

(who, whom)" Do you should represent our company?"

STEP TWO: Substitute HE for WHO, HIM for WHOM.

Do you think (he, him) should represent our company?

You would say he in this case.

THEREFORE: "Tell me WHO –Whom do you think should represent the company?" is correct.

Who is}

Who am}

Page | 66

Note these constructions:

It is I who am the most experienced.

It is he who is

It is he or I who am

It is I or he who is

It is he and I who are ...

Whose – means of whom.

Who's – means who is.

Whose is this notebook?

Who's in the next office?

Would have – is unacceptable for had.

SAY: I wish you had (NOT would have) called earlier.

You all- is unacceptable for you (plural)

SAY: I wish you had not (NOT would have) called earlier.

You all – is unacceptable for you (plural)

SAY: We welcome you, the delegates from Region 5.

You are all welcome Delegates of Negros.

Page | 67

BASIC RULES IN AGREEMENT AND GRAMMAR

1. A verb agrees with its subject in person and in number.

Wrong: They doesn't understand what to do.

Right: They don't understand what to do.

2. The number of noun in a phrase introduced by the preposition "of" does not affect the form of the verb.

Wrong: A list of books were made by Bong.

Right: A list of books was made by Bong.

- 3 .Compound subjects joined by "and" ordinarily take the base form of the verb. Wrong: Here comes Nanding and Manny.

Right: Here come Nanding and Manny

4. When two or more singular subjects are joined by "or" or "nor" the "s" form of the verb is required.

Wrong: A man's success or failure lie in his hands.

Right: A man's success or failure lies in his hands.

5. Intervening phrases introduced by "of, with, together with, as well as, including,

Besides, no less than, in addition to, accompanied by, not, do not affect the form of the verb.

Wrong: The teacher, together with her pupils were there.

Right: The teacher, together with her pupils was there.

6. Compound nouns joined by “and” use the “s” for of the verb if they are regarded as a unit.

Example: Bread and butter was all he asked for.

7. When the subject and predicate nominative differ in number, the verb must agree with the subject “not” the complement.

Wrong: The theme of the essay are the experiences of our

heroes. Right: The theme of the essay is the experiences of our
heroes.

8. Compound subjects joined by “either-or, neither-nor, not only- but also” ordinarily
Take verbs agreeing in number with the nearer subject.

Wrong: Not only the students but also the teacher are learning.

Right: Not only the students but also the teacher is leaning.

9. When the subject comes after the verb make sure that the veb agrees with its
subject.

Wrong: In this school is enrolled several alien students.

Right: In this school are enrolled several alien students.

10. Never begin a sentence with a participle that does not logically modify the

subject of the sentence.

Wrong: walking around the campus, the bell rang.

Right: Walking around the campus, I heard the bell rang.

11. Sentence elements that are grammatically connected should be joined together.

Wrong: I, after the class, went to the movies.

Right: I went to the movies after my class.

12. Modifiers should be placed as near as possible to the words they modify.

Wrong: She rushed into the room just as we are singing the last song
breathless with excitement .

Right: Breathless with excitement, she rushed into the room just as we are
singing the last song.

13. Avoid dangling modifiers

Wrong: Having taken the entrance examinations, the President of the College
accepted me.

14. Ordinarily, "this" and "that" take the "s" form of the verb while "these" and "those"
take the base form of the verb.

Page | 70

Examples: That is good idea.

These are times that try man's soul.

15. The following indefinite pronouns are ordinarily used with the third person. They
take the base form of the verb: "all, both, few, many, several, some."

Examples: All were satisfied.

Both are to be blamed.

16. The following indefinite pronouns, whether singular or plural in meaning are ordinarily used with the third person “S” form of the verb:

“each, everybody, everyone, everything, any, anything, other, somebody, someone, something, one, nothing, nobody, either, neither, another.”

Examples: Each arrives on time

: Everything is in order

17. The “title” of a book is considered singular.

Example: “The Dialogues” of Plato is a great classic.

18. The word “people”, meaning many persons is plural.

Peoples refer to different races.

Page | 71

Examples: The people were excited about the news.

The people vote for Erap’s candidates.

19. The expression “the number of” takes “S” for of the verb, while the expression “a

number of “ takes the base form of the verb.

Examples “A number of books are on reserve in the library.

The number of students in the class is limited.

20. Noun referring to money, time, measurement or distance that is preceded by an

Expression of any amount or quantity is considered singular and takes the

singular form of the verb.

Examples: Five hundred pesos is a long time to wait for you.

Three weeks is a long time to wait for you.

21. The number of the noun that follows an expression “of fraction” or portion determines the number of the verb to be used.

Example: One third of the apples are yours.

Half the apple was eaten by rats.

22. Sentences introduced by “it” take the “s” form of the verb.

Examples: It is time to say goodbye.

It hurts to say goodbye.

Page | 72

23. The number of the subject of a sentence introduced by “there” determines the verb to be used.

Examples: There is a man in the room.

There are days when she is lonely.

There are five schooldays in a week.

24. The verb takes an “S” when it is used in the third person singular of the present tense.

Example: Jerry plays chess vigorously.

25. The expressions “one of the, the number of and a number of” are always followed by plural nouns.

Examples: One of the boys is absent.

A number of books were stolen.

A number of apples were rotten.

26. Some nouns are always plural in form

Examples: measles, mumps, pants, shorts, scissors, trousers.

My scissors are missing.

27. Nouns such as Mathematics, Statistics, Economics, Politics, Physics are used with the singular form of the verb when they refer to an area of study.

Page | 73

Examples: Physics is required for science majors.

Politics, is not dirty per se, but the politicians are the ones making it dirty.

28. Possession is usually shown by adding apostrophe (') or apostrophe and s (s') to a noun

Examples: The boy's club.

: The ladie's club

29. The infinitive of a verb is always in the simple form.

Examples: To love is an adventure.

Long ago, Bong's dream was to live in a forest.

30. Nouns plural in form but singular in meaning (Singular form of the verb)

Examples: News, measles. The news is exciting.

31. Nouns singular in form but function collectively

Examples: information, food, equipment, jewelry; furniture.

THE USE OF FIGURATIVE LANGUAGE

Since literature makes use of effective and affective language. It is proper for the literature teacher to master the various types of figurative language.